

*“Google Will Require Android 16 Compatibility for New Play Store Submissions in 2026”*

[Beginning August 31, 2026](#), new apps or updates must target Android 16. Developers can request an extension to adapt to this change, or their app may become unavailable to new users on newer devices on the Google Play Store. Previously released apps must target Android 15 to avoid this decreased visibility.

This is an annual update meant to ensure app security and functionality remain consistent across newer devices. An API (Application Programming Interface) is a ruleset that defines how software components interact with each other. With each update and iteration, these rules are refined, justifying the need for app updates.

To make this update, developers must run Android Studio and repackage their product as they did at the final stage of their initial release, and upload this repackaged version into the Google Play Console for review. Reaching this point may require more changes for some apps than others.